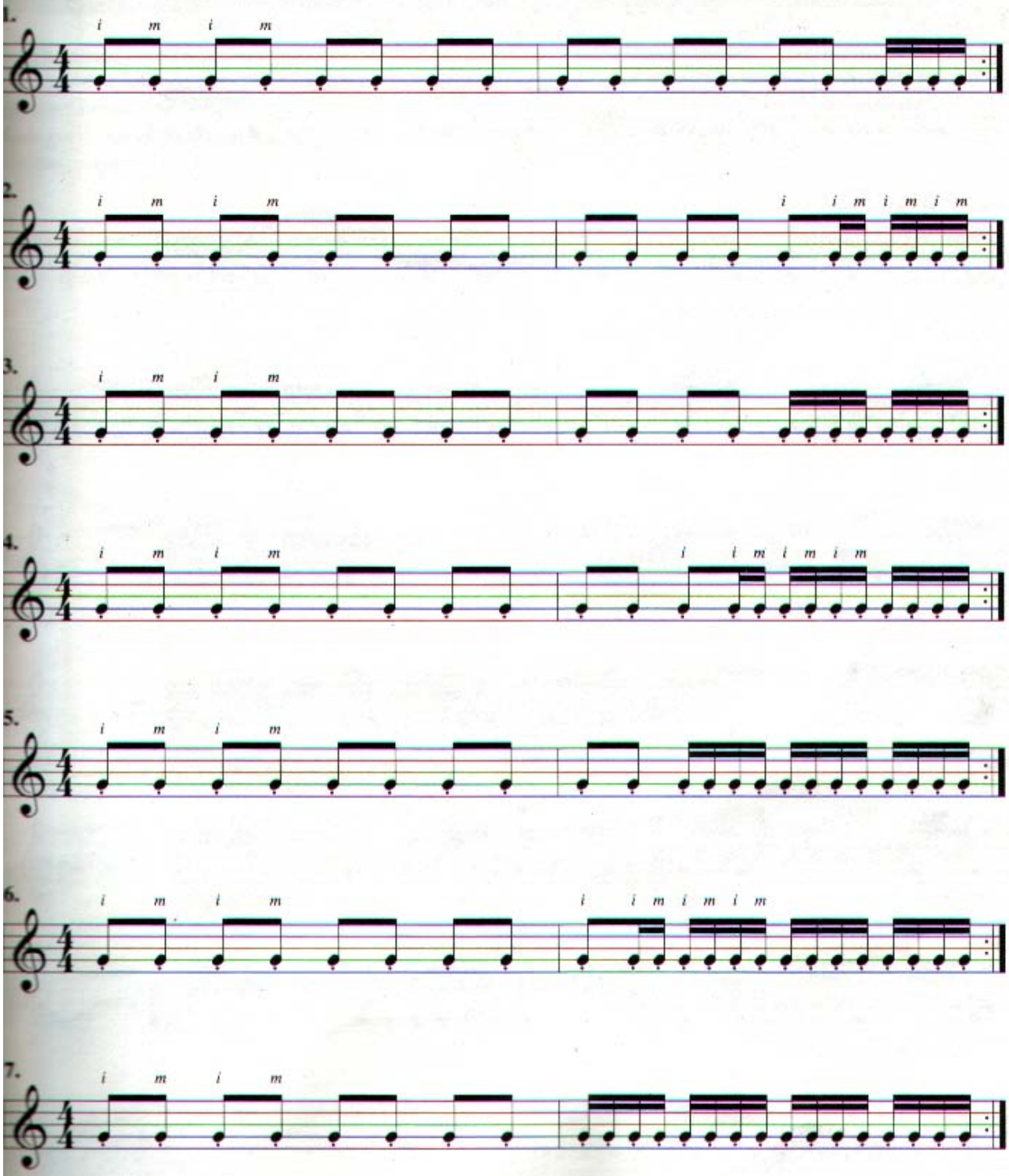
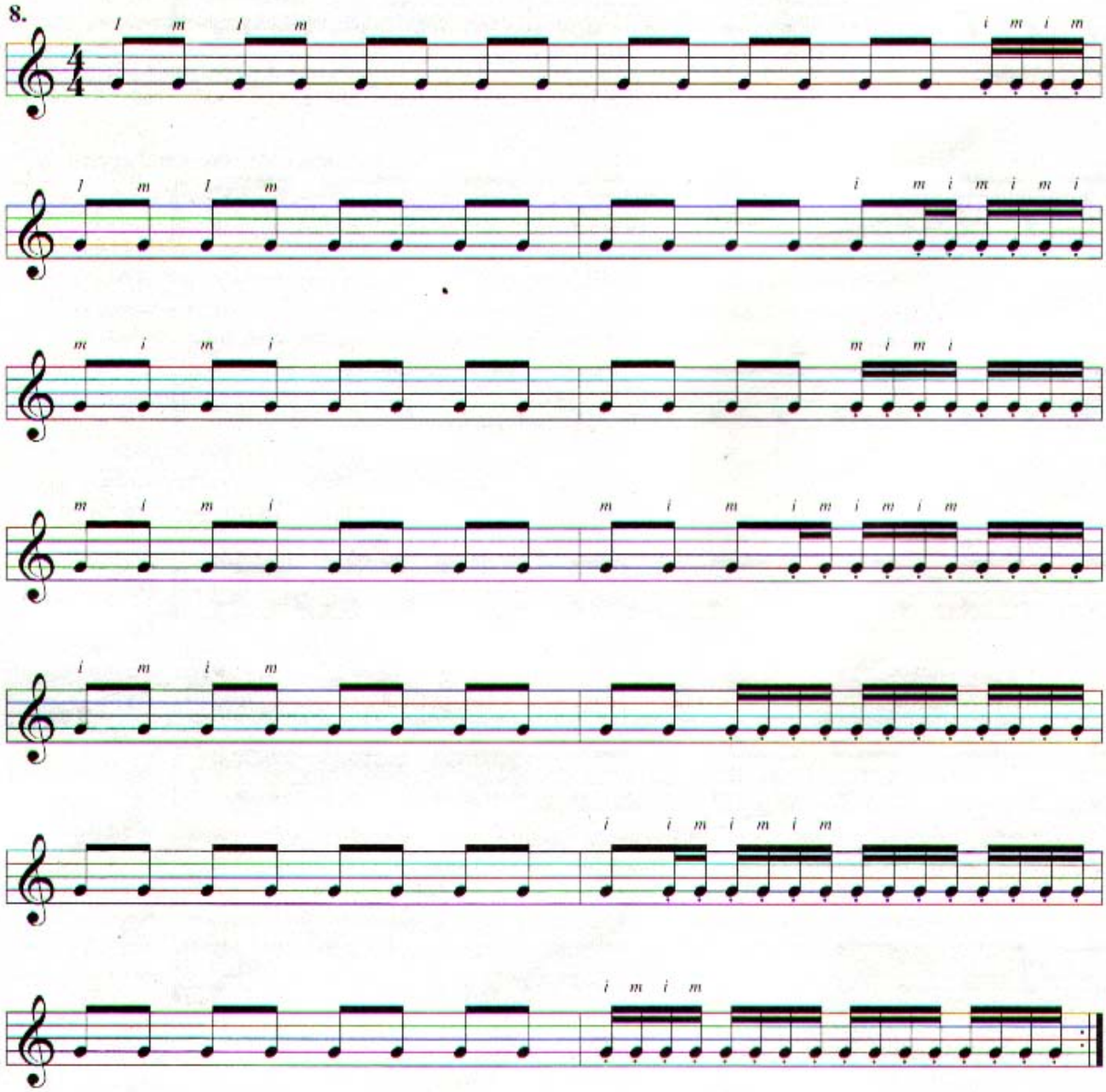
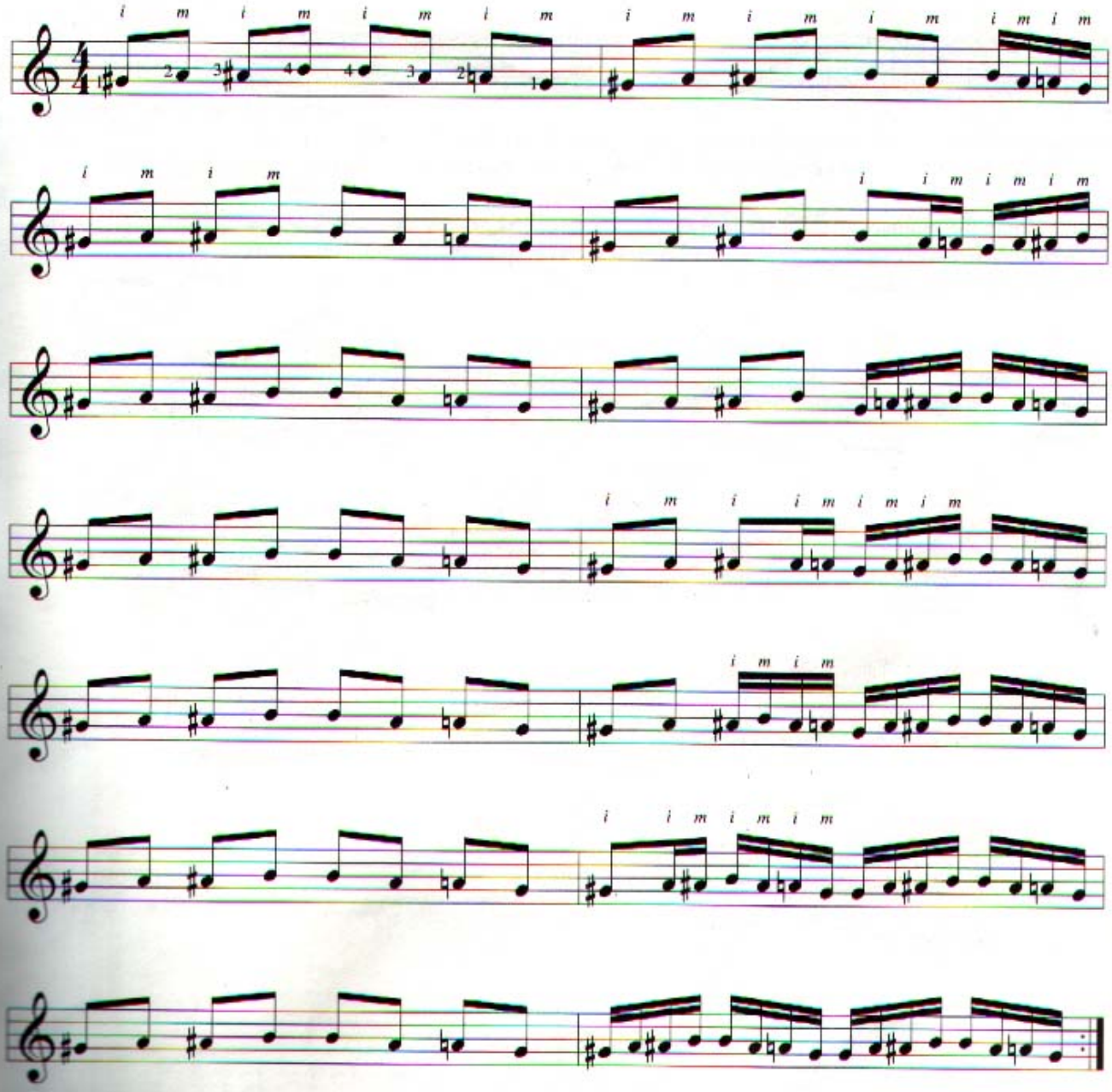

1.
i m i m
2.
i m i m
i i m i m i m
3.
i m i m
4.
i m i m
i i m i m i m
5.
i m i m
6.
i m i m
i i m i m i m
7.
i m i m

8.


l m l m i m i m
l m l m i m i m i m i
m i m i m i m i
m i m i m i m i m i m
i m i m
i i m i m i m
i m i m

Synchronization

Synchronization means playing the right-hand finger at the exact same time as the left-hand finger. In the exercise that follows, set your tempo with the sixteenth notes in mind. Play as slowly as necessary to remain in control of the sixteenth notes. Push yourself to faster tempos a little at a time. When a passage feels good and in control at a given tempo, turn the metronome up just one notch or two until you reach the desired speed.



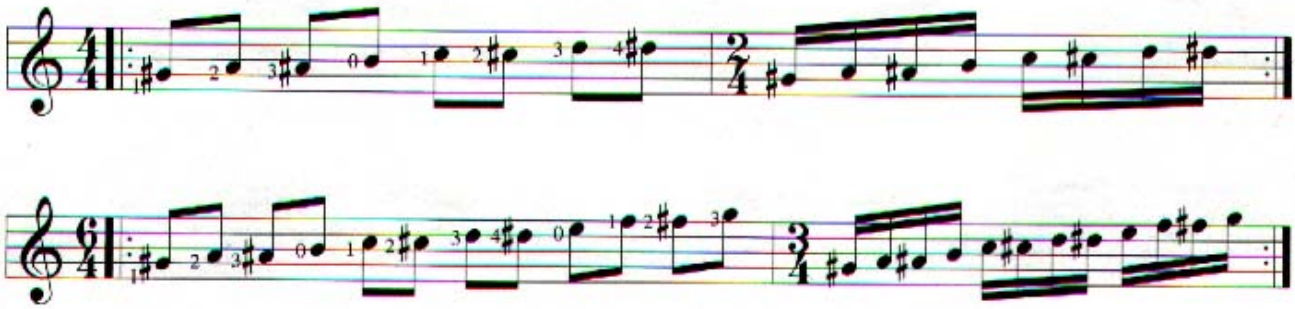
String Crossing

A good deal has already been said about string crossing. It is covered in the "Right-Hand Independence" section on page 37. The exercises presented there are the best ones on which to focus for improving finger accuracy and speed during crossing strings. Also, see the section about marking string crossings on page 71.

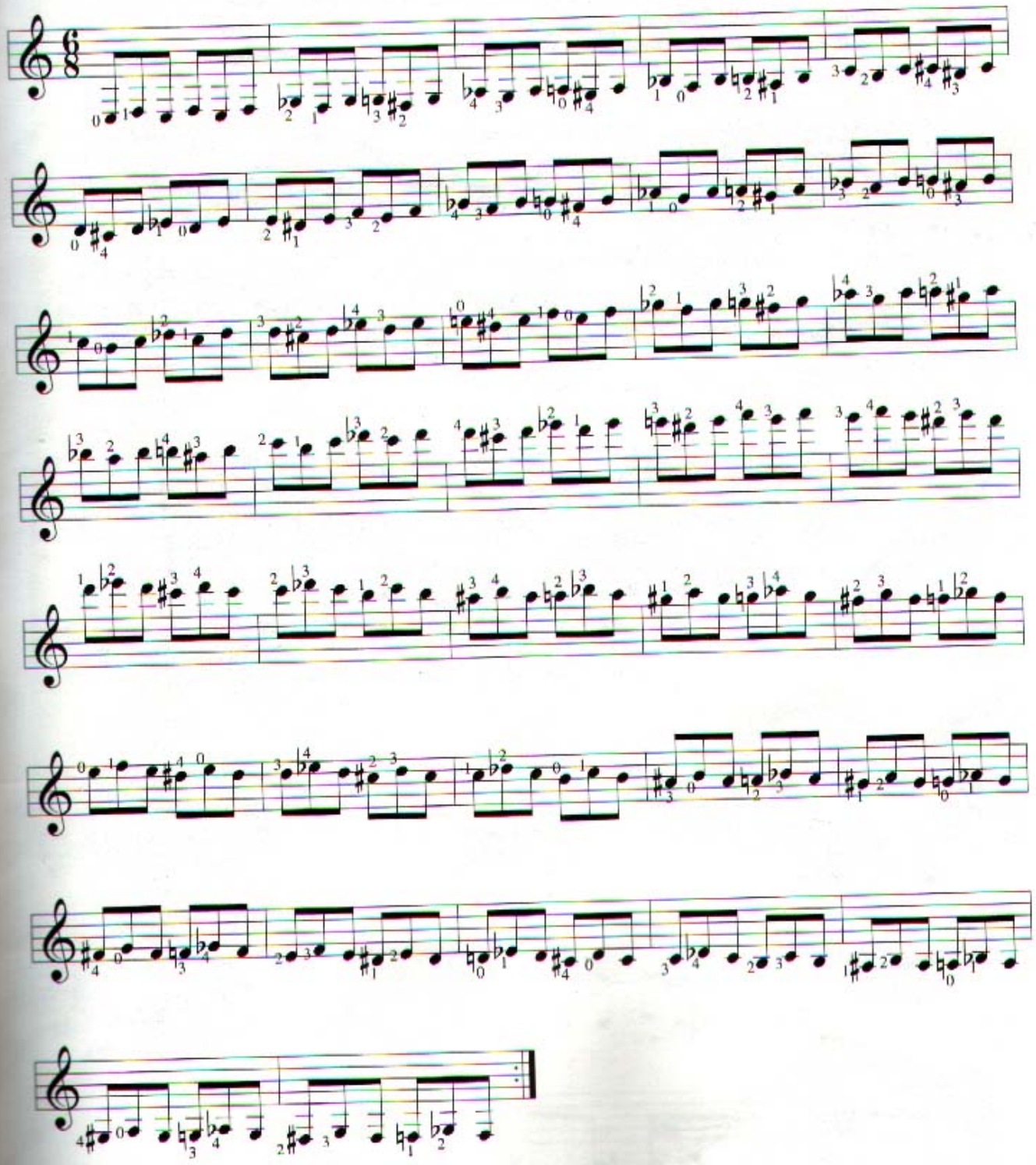
Piecing Things Together

Assuming you've been working on your string crossing, the speed bursts are now comfortably speedy, and your hands are synchronized, the most logical thing to do now is to put everything together.

The easiest skill to acquire in the realm of speed is playing fast on one string. The situation that slows us down considerably is having to switch strings. Familiarize yourself with the next little exercise, but don't stop there. Work out all your most difficult scales the same way.

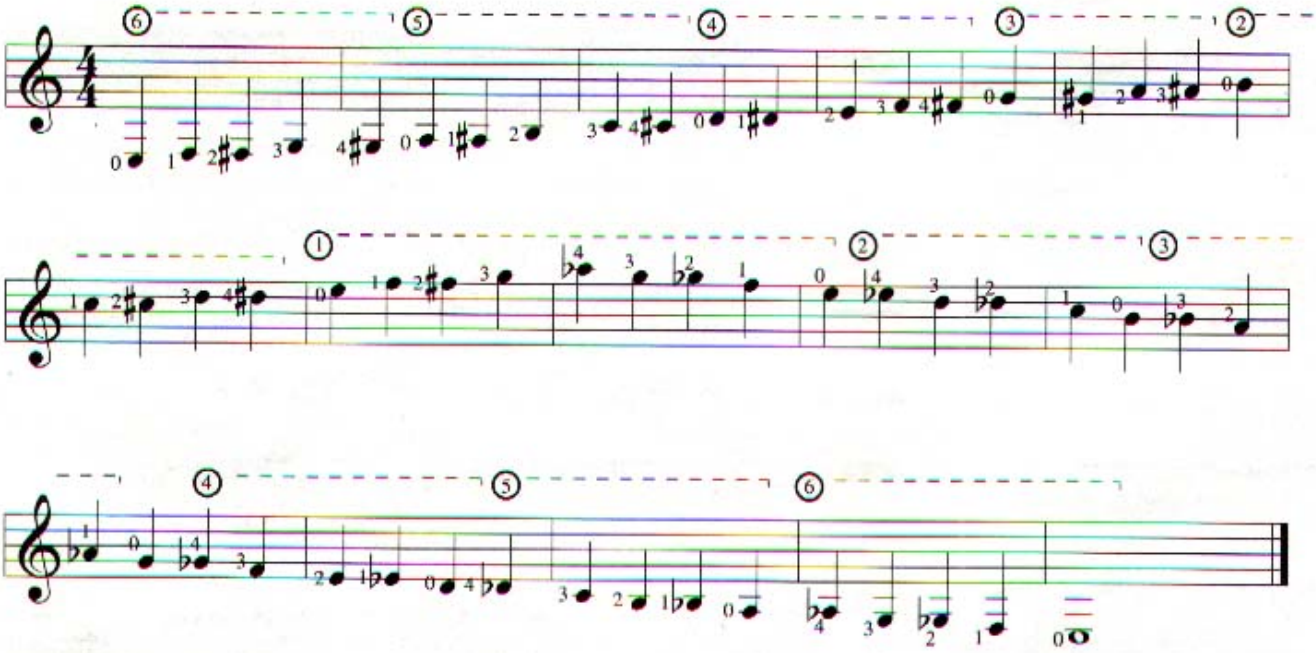


Here is a chromatic scale in groups pf three. This is my favorite exercise for working up speed. I particularly like to push this one up one metronome notch at a time. For technical focus, though, *make sure your hands are synchronized!*

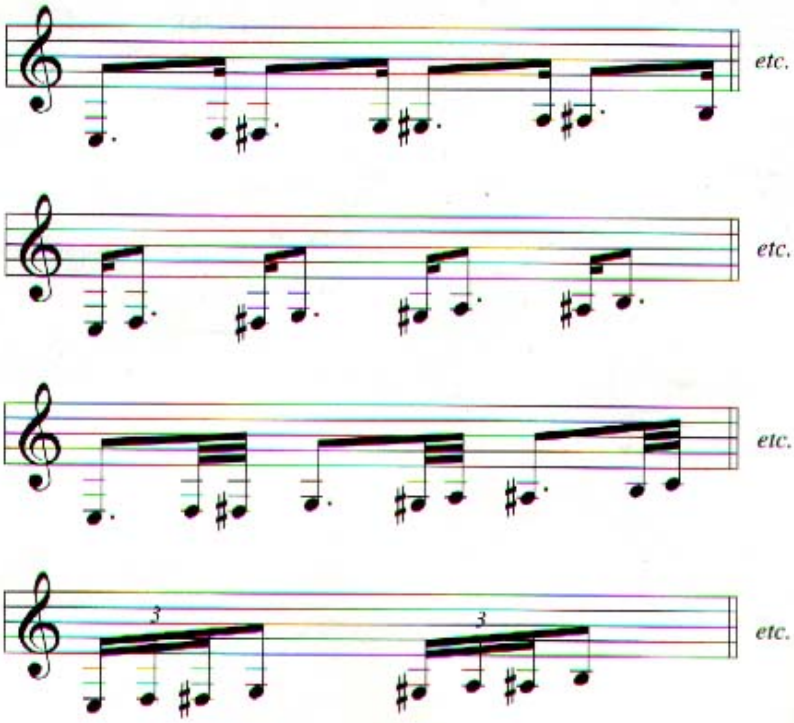


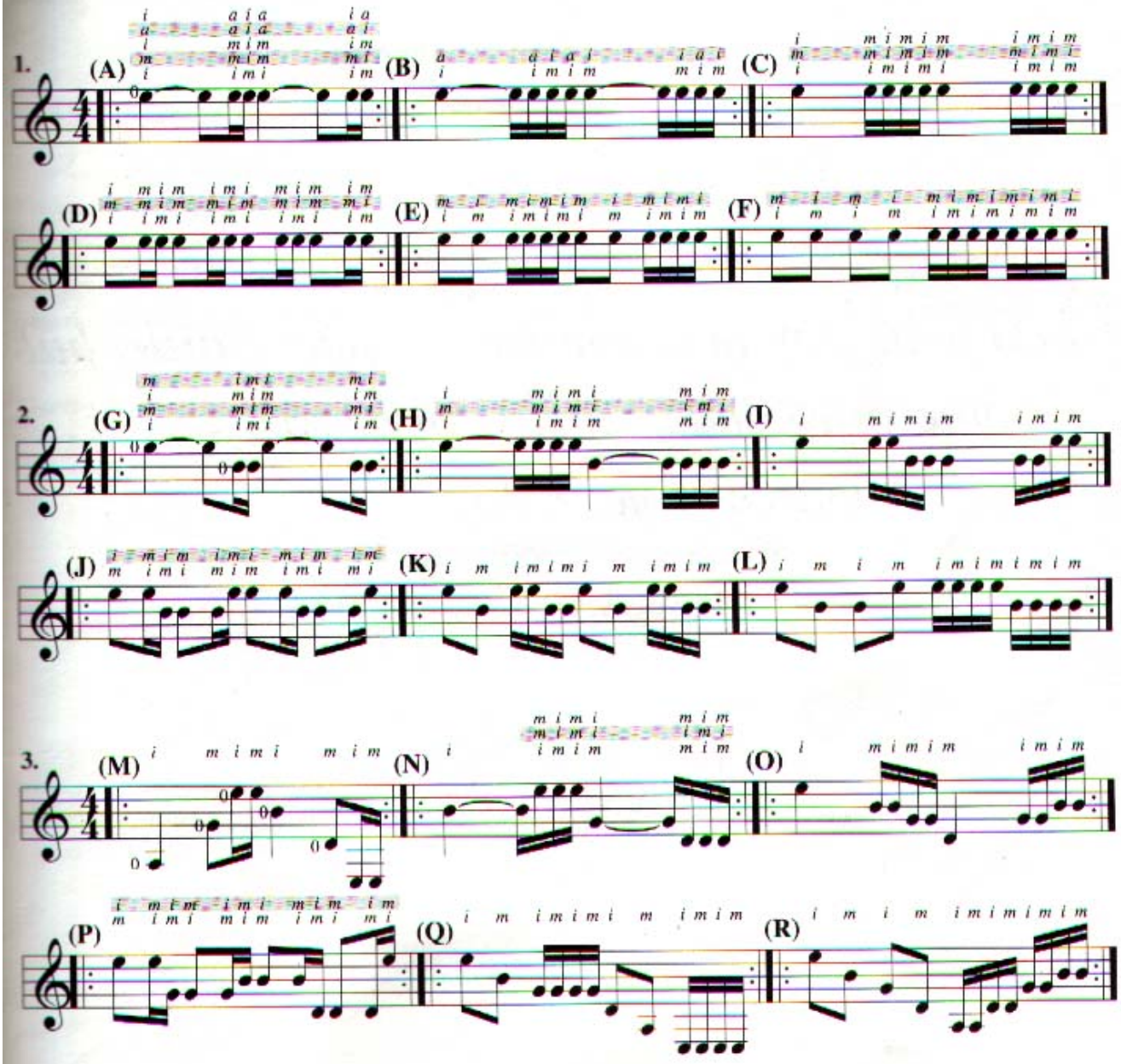
Some Other Speed Aids

Here is a chromatic scale with some rhythmic variations. Practicing scales with various rhythmic variations is invaluable to making them faster and cleaner. Notice that certain rhythmic configurations, including dots, triplets, etc., create short speed burst situations. The variations below are just a few possibilities. Practice them with this chromatic scale fingering. You should apply them to your other scales, as well.



Rhythmic Variations



And now, for more fun, try these! Group #1 concentrates on one string, Group #2 on two strings, and in Group #3... anything goes! Remember, you can only go as fast as you can play the sixteenth notes, so work these out slowly. To reap the maximum benefits from these, think before you play every note, and feel each note as you play it.

Speed Bursts